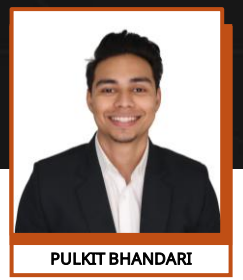
Schulich School of Business

Scaling Consulting in the Age of AI

Evolving Optimus SBR into an AI-Augmented, Continuous Delivery Model

DEAN'S CUP 2026 FINALE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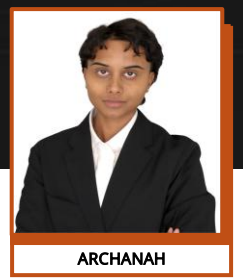
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PRESENTED BY TEAM KEEPIN' IT CASE-UAL

Optimus must evolve into an AI-augmented, execution-led consulting firm, enabled by continuous delivery, to drive scalable, outcome-based value.

Optimus Continuous Delivery Model (CDM)

Optimus CDM | Executive Summary

Case Ask: How can Optimus SBR evolve its delivery model to leverage AI and deliver scalable, continuous client outcomes in an increasingly AI-driven consulting landscape?

A successful solution should:

1. Enable continuous, outcome-driven delivery (beyond one-time projects)
2. Leverage AI to enhance speed, accuracy, and decision-making
3. Create scalable, repeatable delivery models
4. Drive measurable client impact (cost, efficiency, experience)
5. Align with Optimus' execution-focused capabilities

Our analysis identifies:
Four key priorities to remain competitive in an AI-driven consulting market

- Continuous delivery (vs. episodic projects)
- AI-augmented delivery and decisions
- Execution-led differentiation
- Scalable, repeatable models

To remain competitive, Optimus must shift from delivering insights to delivering outcomes - continuously, and embedded within client operations

The solution: **AI-Augmented Operating Model**

Optimus CDM
AI-enabled, subscription-based model embedding execution teams to deliver continuous, outcome-driven value

AI Delivery Pods
Embedded teams using AI to drive real-time insights

AI-Driven Client Engagement
Proactive insights via real-time dashboards and interaction

Which will be seen through

- +30% Recurring Revenue
- +20% Delivery Efficiency
- +30% Client Retention

MARKET LANDSCAPE

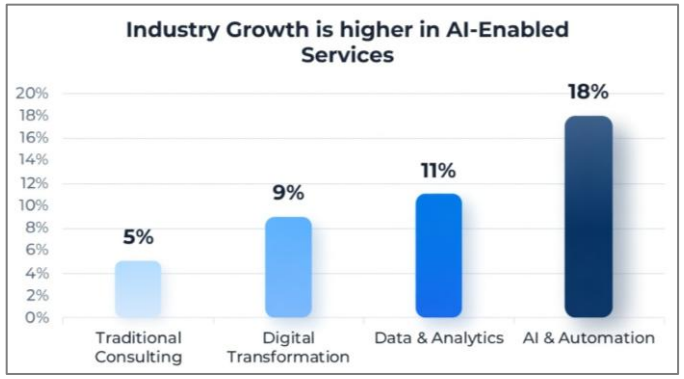
AI is redefining where value is created in consulting, shifting advantage to scalable, AI-enabled execution

Market Overview

- Canadian consulting market: **~C$17–18B**, growing at ~5% annually
- Core industries
  - Financial Services
  - Government
  - Healthcare
- These sectors face
  - **High regulatory pressure**
  - Legacy systems
  - Strong need for transformation

Industry Growth Shift

- AI & automation services are **growing 2–3x faster**, capturing the majority of industry growth
- Clients are shifting spend toward **real-time**, scalable, tech-enabled **solutions**
- Traditional consulting remains stable but lacks high-growth potential



Consulting Value Chain Disruption (SWOT Framework)

Strengths

- **Faster, AI-driven insights**
- Scalable, repeatable delivery
- Improved data-driven decisions

Weaknesses

- **Insight generation commoditized**
- Revenue tied to headcount
- Limited differentiation

Opportunities

- Shift to continuous delivery
- Subscription-based models
- **Execution-led differentiation**

Threats

- **Big 4 AI platform investments**
- Client insourcing capabilities
- Price pressure on services

So, what does this mean for us?

Consulting value is shifting from insight generation to AI-enabled execution

- AI is commoditizing traditional consulting outputs
- Clients expect real-time, measurable outcomes
- Execution is becoming the primary differentiator

To remain competitive, Optimus must transition from project-based delivery to **continuous, embedded, outcome-driven engagement**

AI is fundamentally shifting consulting from episodic advisory to continuous, AI-enabled, execution-driven models

ALTERNATIVES AND THE RECOMMENDED MODEL

Evaluating strategic operating models to scale consulting in an AI-driven market

Optimus Continuous Delivery Model (CDM)

Build Proprietary AI Platform

Develop a **fully owned AI platform** offering analytics, automation, and decision-support tools to clients

PROS
- **High scalability** & IP ownership
- Recurring revenue potential

CONS
- **High cost** ($5M+, long build)
- Outside core capability

Strategic Partnerships with AI Providers

Partner with leading AI and **cloud providers** (e.g., OpenAI, AWS) to integrate tools into consulting delivery

PROS
- Fast access to AI tools
- **Lower upfront investment**

CONS
- **Dependency** on partners
- Limited differentiation

AI-First Workforce Transformation

Upskill consultants in AI, data science, and automation to **enhance delivery** of **existing services**

PROS
- Quick capability uplift
- **Low investment**

CONS
- **Easily replicable**
- No model differentiation

Optimus Continuous Delivery Model

Transition to a subscription-based, **AI-enabled delivery model** with embedded teams driving continuous execution

PROS
- Strong strategic fit
- **Recurring, scalable revenue**
- Differentiated positioning

CONS
- Requires org change
- **Gradual client adoption**

Decision Matrix to evaluate different alternatives

Criteria	AI Platform	Partnerships with AI Providers	AI-First Workforce	Continuous Delivery Model
Strategic Fit	3	4	4	5
Scalability	5	4	3	5
Time to Market	2	4	5	4
Cost	2	4	5	4
Differentiation	5	3	3	5
Total	**17**	**19**	**20**	**23**

While multiple strategic paths exist, only a continuous, AI-enabled, execution-led operating model aligns with Optimus' strengths and future market dynamics

OPTIMUS CONTINUOUS DELIVERY MODEL

An AI-augmented operating model transforming delivery, client engagement, and talent to enable continuous, outcome-driven consulting at scale

Optimus Continuous Delivery Model (CDM)

Objective

How should Optimus SBR evolve its operating model to deliver scalable, AI-enabled consulting outcomes while maintaining differentiation and execution excellence over the next 5 years?

01 Delivery Model Transformation

- Traditional consulting is project-based and episodic
- AI enables continuous insight generation and automation
- **Clients demand** real-time, **outcome-driven engagement**

Implication: Optimus must transition to a continuous, embedded delivery model

02 Client Engagement Evolution

- **Engagements are currently reactive** and project-triggered
- Clients increasingly expect proactive, always-on support
- Limited visibility into ongoing value delivered post-project

Implication: Optimus must shift to AI-driven, continuous client engagement

03 Talent & Operating Model Shift

- **Consultants spend significant time** on manual analysis & reporting
- AI can automate low-value tasks, augmenting productivity
- Future roles require tech fluency + execution focus

Implication: Optimus must adopt an AI-augmented workforce model

Position for Scale

- Standardized delivery pods
- Repeatable, scalable models

Execute with Discipline

- Pilot-first rollout
- KPI-driven performance tracking

Strengthen Differentiation

- Execution-led positioning
- Outcome-based client relationships

An AI-augmented operating model - combining continuous delivery, proactive engagement, and AI-enabled talent, positions Optimus to deliver scalable, differentiated, and outcome-driven consulting in the age of AI

IMPLEMENTATION ROADMAP

A phased, pilot-led roadmap enables Optimus to validate, refine, and scale CDM with minimal risk

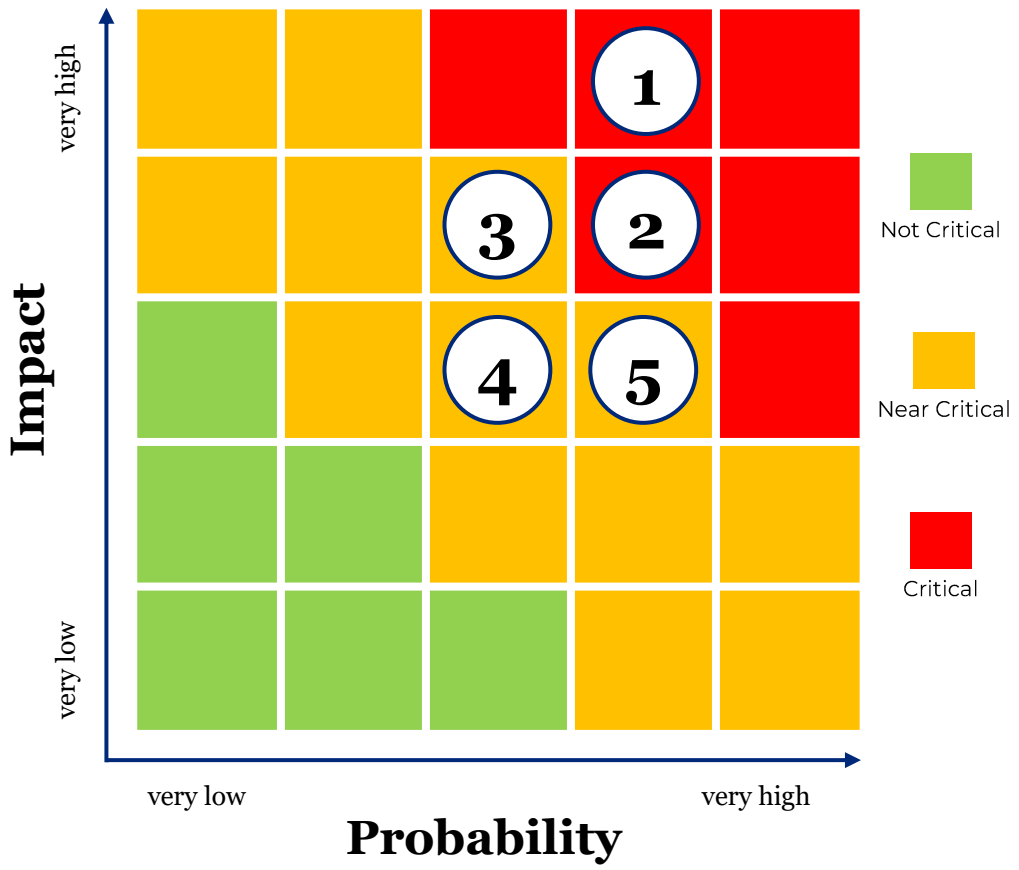
Task	Establish CDM governance & pilot structure	Build AI & delivery infrastructure	Deploy AI Delivery Pods & engagement model	Monitor performance & refine model	Scale CDM across clients & industries	Institutionalize operating model transformation
Actions	❑ Form pilot team & pod structure ❑ Select 2–3 pilot clients ❑ Define KPIs & success metrics	❑ Integrate AI tools & dashboards ❑ Set up data pipelines & workflows ❑ Develop Pod playbook (v1)	❑ Launch AI Delivery Pods ❑ Implement subscription + KPI pricing ❑ Enable always-on client dashboards	❑ Track KPIs (efficiency, satisfaction) ❑ Refine pods, workflows, pricing ❑ Build ROI case studies	❑ Expand to 8–10 clients ❑ Standardize delivery pods ❑ Launch CDM GTM strategy	❑ Shift to outcome-based incentives ❑ Roll out AI training firm-wide ❑ Build scale-ready toolkit
Estimations	**$150K – $200K**	**$150K – $200K**	**$250K – $350K**	**$200K – $250K**	**$180K – $220K**	**$120K – $180K**

	Stage 1				Stage 2				Stage 3			
Timeline	**2026**									**2027**		
	April	***May***	***Jun***	***Jul***	***Aug***	***Sep***	***Oct***	***Nov***	***Dec***	***Jan***	***Feb***	***Mar***
Pilot Foundation & Capability Setup	Establish CDM governance & pilot structure		Build AI & delivery infrastructure									
Pilot Execution & Model Refinement				Deploy AI Delivery Pods & engagement model			Monitor performance & refine model					
Scale & Operating Model Integration									Scale CDM across clients & industries		Institutionalize operating model transformation	

RISKS AND MITIGATION STRATEGY

Key risks in transitioning to CDM are manageable through structured governance, talent enablement, and phased adoption

	Risk Identified	Mitigation Strategy
1	**Organizational Resistance to Change**	**Change Enablement Framework**
	Shift from billable hours to outcome-based delivery may slow internal adoption	Align incentives, pilot rollout, and internal success cases to drive adoption
2	**Talent Capability Gap in AI**	**AI Upskilling Program**
	Limited AI skills may reduce effectiveness of delivery and pod performance	Role-based training, AI copilots, and pod-level AI champions
3	**Client Resistance to Subscription Model**	**Pilot Transition Model**
	Clients may hesitate to shift from project-based to subscription engagement	Hybrid pricing, pilot ROI proof, and phased onboarding approach
4	**AI Output Reliability & Trust Issues**	**Human-in-the-Loop Governance**
	Inconsistent AI outputs may reduce client confidence and decision trust	Validation layers, QA workflows, and continuous monitoring
5	**Competitive Pressure from Larger Firms**	**Execution-Led Differentiation Strategy**
	Big 4 and tech firms scaling AI may intensify competition	Focus on embedded delivery, industry pods, and outcome-based value



A pilot-led, controlled approach enables Optimus to mitigate risks while scaling a sustainable, AI-enabled operating model

CONCLUSION

Positioning Optimus to lead the shift to continuous, AI-enabled, execution-driven consulting

Issues

- AI is commoditizing traditional consulting outputs
- Clients demand real-time, measurable outcomes
- Project-based models limit scalability and differentiation

Problem

Consulting firms struggle to deliver continuous, outcome-driven value at scale in an AI-driven market

Solution

Optimus CDM - an AI-augmented, continuous delivery model embedding execution teams to drive scalable, outcome-based value

Components

Continuous Delivery Model

Subscription-based, embedded delivery replacing episodic projects

AI-Driven Client Engagement

Real-time dashboards and proactive, always-on interaction

AI-Augmented Workforce

AI copilots enabling consultants to focus on execution and impact

Impact

+30% client retention

Higher engagement through continuous delivery

+20% delivery efficiency

Reduced time-to-insight and cost per engagement

+30% recurring revenue

Faster scaling through standardized delivery pods

Appendix-1: **Optimus CDM Dashboard**

Appendix-2: **Risk & Mitigation Framework for CDM Transition**

Optimus Continuous Delivery Model (CDM)

- Structured governance model to manage transition risks through clear ownership and accountability
- Phased implementation approach (pilot → scale) to reduce disruption and validate outcomes early
- AI capability development via role-based training, copilots, and internal champions
- Client transition support through hybrid pricing models and gradual onboarding
- Quality assurance & monitoring with human-in-the-loop validation and continuous feedback loops
- Competitive positioning through embedded delivery, industry pods, and outcome-driven value

Implication: Risks are proactively managed through a controlled, scalable, and capability-led transformation approach.

Appendix-3: **CDM Economics & Operating Model**

Optimus Continuous Delivery Model (CDM)

AI Delivery Pod Structure

- 1 Engagement Lead (client ownership)
- 2-3 Consultants (execution & workflow integration)
- 1 Data / AI Specialist (analytics, automation, dashboards)
- Shared AI tools & platform layer

Unit Economics Per Pod

- Annual Cost: **~$0.9M – $1.2M**
- Annual Revenue (per client subscription): **~$1.5M - $2.0M**
- Target Margin: **~30–40% at scale**

Why CDM Is Feasible for Optimus (Cost vs Big Firms)

Large Consulting Firms (Platform-Heavy Strategy)

- Accenture
  - **~$3B AI investment (2023–2026)**
  - Focus: proprietary platforms, large AI ecosystems, massive talent hiring
- McKinsey & Company / Boston Consulting Group / Deloitte
  - **Hundreds of millions** invested in AI labs, tools, and workforce transformation
  - Heavy investment in proprietary technology and internal AI platforms
- **Optimus CDM Approach (Asset-Light Strategy)**
- Use **existing AI ecosystems** (OpenAI, cloud platforms, analytics tools)
- Focus investment on:
  - AI tools & dashboards
  - delivery pod setup
  - consultant AI training

Estimated pilot investment: ~$1–1.2M

- Big firms invest billions to **build technology platforms**
- **Optimus CDM focuses on delivery innovation**, not building technology from scratch
- This makes CDM **lower cost, faster to implement, and scalable**

Appendix-4: **Shift Toward Continuous, AI-Enabled Consulting**

Optimus Continuous Delivery Model (CDM)

Similar approaches are emerging across leading consulting firms

- **Managed / Continuous Consulting**
  - Accenture offers managed services with **long-term embedded teams**
  - Focus on **continuous improvement and KPI-driven outcomes**

- **AI-Augmented Consulting**
  - McKinsey & Company, Boston Consulting Group, Deloitte integrating **AI into consulting workflows**
  - AI used for **analysis, research, and automation**

- **Pod / Subscription-Based Delivery**
  - Globant launched **AI Pods**
  - Clients pay **subscription for ongoing AI-enabled consulting teams**

- **Key Insight**
  - Industry moving toward **continuous, AI-enabled consulting**
  - **CDM integrates these trends into one scalable operating model**

Revenue Impact of AI & Continuous Consulting Strategies

- **Accenture**
  - Total revenue: **~$69.7B** (2025)
  - AI services revenue: **~$2.7B**
  - AI bookings: **~$5.9B** in new contracts

Advanced AI generated $1.1B revenue in one quarter

Shows strong demand for AI-enabled consulting and managed services

- **Boston Consulting Group**
  - Total revenue: **~$13.5B**
  - AI consulting revenue: **~$2.7B** annually
  - AI is now one of BCG's fastest-growing business lines

- **Globant**
  - Total revenue: **~$2.4B** annually
  - AI Pods subscription model:
  - **$20.6M** ARR currently
  - **$283M** sales pipeline

Shows early traction of subscription-based AI consulting

Key Insight

AI consulting already generates billions in revenue for leading firms

Subscription / continuous consulting models are growing rapidly